

Muhammad Rafay Waqar

linkedin.com/in/rafaywaqar · +1 (530) 608-4289 · rafaywaqar2004@gmail.com

SUMMARY

Policy analyst with hands-on experience at the IMF and World Bank Group (achieved through participation of UCD Washington Program), specializing in macroeconomic research, stakeholder engagement, and data-driven policy analysis for MENA and South Asian constituencies. Published author of 12+ op-eds in national newspapers on political economy and international affairs. Multilingual communicator pursuing a career in geopolitical risk analysis, AI governance, and policy research.

EDUCATION

B.A. in Political Science | Minor in Technology Management — University of California, Davis Class of 2026

EXPERIENCE

- Economic Analyst Intern** — International Monetary Fund, Washington DC 08/2024 – 09/2024
- Conducted macroeconomic and financial policy analysis for the OEDMD constituency (Algeria, Ghana, Iran, Libya, Morocco, Pakistan, Tunisia), producing impact assessment briefs to support IMF Executive Board deliberations across 7 member countries
 - Delivered quantitative research, stakeholder briefings, and policy recommendations to the Executive Director and Senior Advisor, synthesizing data from IMF surveillance reports and member country datasets
- Policy Research Intern** — The World Bank Group, Washington DC 07/2024 – 08/2024
- Supported the Executive Director's office by analyzing policy reports and drafting strategic content for work programs spanning 8 MENA countries; contributed to cross-functional stakeholder engagement across government and multilateral partners
 - Developed country fact sheets and sectoral strategy input for MENA programs; conducted targeted research and data analysis for the Pakistan Country Strategy Framework 2024
- International Student Representative** — ASUCD, UC Davis 05/2024 – 05/2025
- Elected to represent 6,000+ international students; secured funding for multiple student organizations through structured advocacy and stakeholder negotiation with university administration
 - Organized 10+ cross-cultural panels, workshops, and events; facilitated direct dialogue between students and administration to advance policy changes for the international student community
- MENASA Resources Community Organizer** — UC Davis 10/2023 – 07/2024
- Planned and executed 15+ community events (speaker series, cultural nights, workshops), averaging 50+ attendees per event; grew program reach by establishing 5+ organizational partnerships
 - Developed digital outreach and strategic communications plan to strengthen MENASA community infrastructure across campus
- Business & Economics Research Intern** — SouthAsia Magazine, Lahore, Pakistan 12/2023 – 01/2024
- Researched and reported on international business, financial trends, and political-economic developments across South and Southeast Asia; translated complex macroeconomic and trade data into accessible editorial content
 - Maintained editorial accuracy through rigorous fact-checking and copyediting across print and digital formats
- Policy Intern** — CoRe Alliance (Pakistan's first packaging recycling alliance), Washington DC 07/2023 – 09/2023
- Prepared policy briefs on circular economy frameworks and emerging UN global plastic treaty; identified partnership opportunities across 10+ multilateral organizations
 - Developed a legal and regulatory roadmap for establishing the Alliance's first international office in Washington D.C.
- Founder** — Water4Pakistan, Lahore, Pakistan 2019 – 2022
- Founded a multi-platform social media advocacy initiative on water conservation and pollution across Facebook, Instagram, and Twitter; crowdfunded \$5,000 to fund clean drinking water access for school-going children in rural Punjab

SELECTED WRITING · OP-EDS & FEATURES

Published 12+ op-eds in The News International, The Express Tribune, and Dawn on political economy, international affairs, and social policy (2018–present).

- “Governing AI,” *The News International*
- “Economic Agenda,” *The News International*
- “Ukraine: Global Food Security,” *The News International*
- “Genocides' Unseen Epidemics,” *The Express Tribune*
- “Tackling Plastic,” *The News International*

SKILLS

Policy Analysis · Macroeconomic Research · Stakeholder Engagement · Report Writing · Data Analysis · Strategic Communications · Statistical Analysis (R) · Stata · Python · SQL · Tableau · Power BI · Microsoft Office Suite

LANGUAGES

English, Urdu, Punjabi, Hindi (Native) — French, Persian (Basic)